

● EASY

● STANDARD ENGLISH CONVENTIONS

● ANSWER KEY

Standard English Conventions

05

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

Q1**B****B. content,**

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a subordinate clause and a main clause. This choice correctly uses a comma to mark the boundary between the subordinate clause (“Because...content”) and the main clause (“scientists...settlements”).

Choice A is incorrect. Joining the subordinate clause (“Because...content”) and the clause that follows (“scientists...settlements”) with the conjunction “and” results in an ungrammatical sentence that lacks a main clause. Choice C is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the subordinate clause and the main clause with appropriate punctuation. Choice D is incorrect. Joining the subordinate clause (“Because...content”) and the clause that follows (“scientists...settlements”) with a comma and the conjunction “and” results in an ungrammatical sentence that lacks a main clause.

Q2**D****D. malfunctioned**

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense. In this choice, the past tense verb “malfunctioned” is consistent with the other past tense verbs (“ignited” and “was”) used to describe the destruction of the original Globe Theatre.

Choice A is incorrect because the present tense verb “malfunctions” isn’t consistent with the other past tense verbs used to describe the destruction of the original Globe Theatre. Choice B is incorrect because the future tense verb “will malfunction” isn’t consistent with the other past tense verbs used to describe the destruction of the original Globe Theatre. Choice C is incorrect because the present perfect tense verb “has malfunctioned” isn’t consistent with the other past tense verbs used to describe the destruction of the original Globe Theatre.

Q3

C

C. not, aerobic

Choice C is the best answer. A comma is the appropriate way to link the dependent clause “While...not” and the independent clause that follows.

Choice A is incorrect. This choice creates a run-on sentence error. “While...not” is a dependent clause, which must be separated from the independent clause that follows with some sort of punctuation. Choice B is incorrect. This choice creates a sentence fragment. “While one requires oxygen and one does not” isn’t an independent clause, so it can’t stand alone as a complete sentence. Choice D is incorrect. This choice creates a punctuation error. “While one requires oxygen and one does not” isn’t an independent clause, so it can’t be linked to the clause that follows with a semicolon.

Q4

D

D. He

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is pronoun-antecedent agreement. The singular pronoun “he” agrees in number with the singular antecedent “Félix González-Torres,” and it clearly indicates that González-Torres created the additional installations.

Choice A is incorrect because the plural noun phrase “they all” doesn’t agree in number with the singular antecedent “Félix González-Torres,” and it doesn’t clearly indicate that he (González-Torres) created the additional installations. Choice B is incorrect because the plural pronoun “those” doesn’t agree in number with the singular antecedent “Félix González-Torres,” and it doesn’t clearly indicate that he (González-Torres) created the additional installations. Choice C is incorrect because the plural pronoun “both” doesn’t agree in number with the singular antecedent “Félix González-Torres,” and it doesn’t clearly indicate that he (González-Torres) created the additional installations.

Q5

A

A. of

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a preposition and its complement. No punctuation is needed between the preposition “of” and its complement, the noun phrase “healing, self-discovery, and memory.”

Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between a preposition and its complement. Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between a preposition and its complement. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between a preposition and its complement.

Q6

C

C. It

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is pronoun-antecedent agreement. The singular pronoun “it” agrees in number with the singular antecedent “multitask learning” and clearly indicates what multitask learning involves.

Choice A is incorrect because the plural demonstrative pronoun “those” doesn’t agree in number with the singular antecedent “multitask learning.” Choice B is incorrect because the plural pronoun “they” doesn’t agree in number with the singular antecedent “multitask learning.” Choice D is incorrect because the indefinite pronoun “some” is ambiguous in this context; the resulting sentence leaves unclear what exactly “involves training computer models.”

Q7

B

B. preferred the

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation use between a verb and its object. No punctuation is needed between the verb "preferred" and its object "the sound of a bent bell over that of a straight one." The object helps complete the idea of the verb—in this case, it explains what type of sound Gillespie preferred—and any punctuation between the two results in an ungrammatical sentence.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the verb and its object. Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the verb and its object. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the verb and its object.

Q8

B

B. illuminates

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense. In this choice, the present tense verb "illuminates" is consistent with the other present tense verb ("is") used to describe the sculpture, correctly indicating that the sculpture habitually glows ("each night") and that the lamp inside is the source of its illumination.

Choice A is incorrect because the future progressive tense verb "will be illuminating" isn't consistent with the other present tense verb used to describe the sculpture and the source of its glow. Choice C is incorrect because the modal "would," which is used to indicate a typical behavior in the past, isn't consistent with the other present tense verb used to describe the sculpture and the source of its glow. Choice D is incorrect because the past tense verb "illuminated" isn't consistent with the other present tense verb used to describe the sculpture and the source of its glow.

Q9**A****A.** value, but

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the coordination of independent clauses within a sentence. An independent clause is a phrase containing a subject and a verb that can stand on its own as a sentence. This choice uses a comma and the coordinating conjunction “but” to join the first independent clause (“underlines...lower a book’s value”) and the second independent clause (“such markings...can be a gold mine to scholars”) to create a compound sentence.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a run-on sentence. The two independent clauses are fused without punctuation and/or a conjunction. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can’t be used in this way to mark the boundary between two independent clauses. Choice D is incorrect because a comma is needed to mark the boundary between two coordinated independent clauses.

Q10**B****B.** was

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verbs to express tense in a sentence. In this choice, the past tense verb “was,” used in conjunction with the prepositional phrase “from outside the United States,” correctly indicates that in the 1860s nearly 30% of the population in Los Angeles wasn’t from the US.

Choice A is incorrect because the present progressive tense verb “is being” doesn’t indicate that the claim about Los Angeles’s population refers to the population back in the 1860s. Choice C is incorrect because the present tense verb “is” doesn’t indicate that the claim about Los Angeles’s population refers to the population back in the 1860s. Choice D is incorrect because the future tense verb “will be” doesn’t indicate that the claim about Los Angeles’s population refers to the population back in the 1860s.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

Generated 2026-05-29 · cb-educator-question-bank